

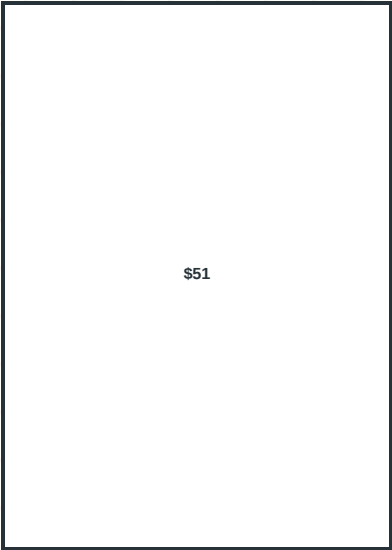
Backpack Story Ending Card Pack

Sixteen paper cards help writers close fictional stories with final choices, returning objects, echo lines, and closing images.

Audience: Families, homeschool groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable ending cards plus adult guide tools, ending routines, take-home ending slips, and optional share prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline story practice.



\$51

Included

- 16 printable backpack ending cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional ending safety notes
- Backpack ending coaching moves
- Privacy and family handoff notes
- Pack reset notes
- Six adult-led ending routines
- Ten take-home ending slips
- Eight optional share prompts
- Provider-ready PDF and ZIP artifact

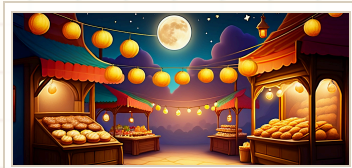
Ending coaching

Before the session • Print the ending cards, backpack sleeve, blank slips, and adult guide before writers gather. • Use a pretend paper backpack only; no real bags, labels, or private items are part of the activity. • Set out pencils and scrap paper for fictional closing choices, final feelings, object returns, echo lines, and final images. • Tell writers every ending belongs to an invented story world and can be changed gently. • Keep the session adult-led, offline, and paper-only from the first card to the last slip.	Backpack ending setup • Place three ending cards in the pretend paper backpack and keep the rest face down. • Put one blank slip beside each card for the writer's chosen closing detail. • Invite the writer to pick one ending job: return an object, echo an earlier line, choose a final feeling, or draw the last image. • Ask the adult helper to read choices aloud and let the writer select one paper path. • Keep every label invented, broad, and tied to the story page rather than personal life.	Story ending coaching • Ask what choice the character makes on the final page and write it in one short phrase. • Ask which pretend object comes back and what it means now. • Help the writer echo one earlier story word without copying a whole scene. • Name one final feeling that is calm, clear, or hopeful. • Use gentle revision by asking what can be clearer, softer, or more complete on the ending slip.
Privacy and safety notes • Keep the activity on invented story words, broad pretend places, and paper-only choices. • If a writer mentions a narrow real-world fact, replace it with an invented story label. • Keep completed slips with the adult helper or send one paper slip to a family reader. • Use only fictional characters, pretend objects, broad story places, and made-up closing lines. • Skip any prompt that feels like collecting private details instead of shaping a fictional ending.	Family handoff • Send one chosen ending slip with a note that the activity stays adult-led and offline. • Invite the family reader to ask about the character's final choice, not about private life. • Offer one fresh blank slip for a gentler alternate ending. • Tell families that invented labels and made-up places are the safest way to keep the story playful. • Let the writer decide whether to read a line aloud or simply point to the final image.	Reset • Collect the cards, blank slips, pencils, and paper backpack sleeve. • Remove any slip with narrow real-world facts and rewrite it as an invented story detail if the adult keeps it. • Shuffle ending cards so the next group sees a fresh mix. • Store finished fictional slips separately from unused blanks.

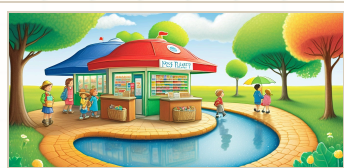
Use one backpack ending card at a time. Keep every choice broad, invented, and screen-free.

Sixteen ending-card worlds

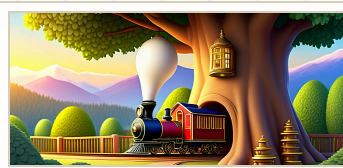
Pick a world image, then close one fictional story with a pretend backpack ending card.



AGES 6-8
Moon Muffin Market



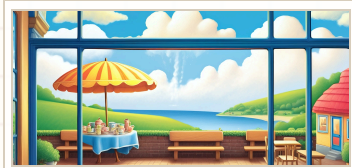
AGES 6-8
Puddle Planet Post Office



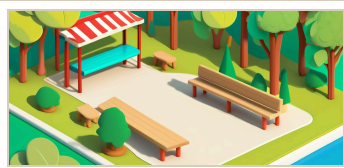
AGES 7-9
Buttonwood Library Train



AGES 7-9
Button Bakery Map Mix-Up



AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



AGES 7-9
Pocket Park Notice Board



AGES 7-9
Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



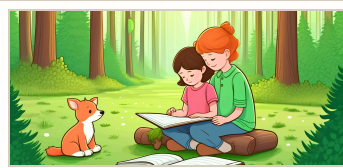
AGES 7-9
Acorn Avenue Errand Office



AGES 8-10
Seed Library Map Room



AGES 8-10
Rain Gauge Railway



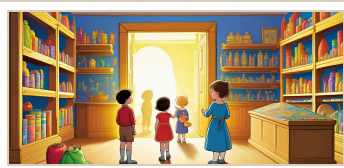
AGES 8-10
Moss Message Observatory



AGES 8-10
Tidepool Timekeepers Lab



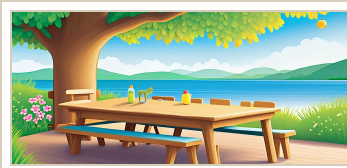
AGES 10-11
Revision River Ferry



AGES 10-11
Clue Label Tower Museum



AGES 10-11
Compass Craft Academy



AGES 10-11
Binding Day Boardwalk

Choose the backpack ending rhythm

Object Comes Back Writers who need a concrete way to close the story. 1. Adult chooses one ending card and asks which pretend object mattered earlier. 2. Writer writes how the object appears again near the end. 3. Adult asks what the object means after the character's final choice. 4. Writer writes one closing sentence that returns the object gently.	Echo Line Close Writers practicing a satisfying repeated phrase. 1. Adult helps the writer pick one harmless word or short phrase from earlier in the story. 2. Writer changes the phrase slightly so it feels new at the end. 3. Adult asks what feeling the echo should leave. 4. Writer writes the echo as the last spoken or narrated line.
Final Feeling Fold Ending a story with emotional clarity. 1. Adult places three feeling slips beside one ending card. 2. Writer picks one gentle final feeling for the character. 3. Adult asks what choice helped the character reach that feeling. 4. Writer writes one sentence that shows the feeling through action.	Last Image Window Writers who think in pictures before sentences. 1. Adult asks the writer to sketch or name the final image on a blank slip. 2. Writer adds one color, sound, or tiny motion to the image. 3. Adult asks why that image belongs at the end. 4. Writer turns the image into one closing sentence.
Choice And Consequence Showing that an ending follows from a character decision. 1. Adult asks what the character finally chooses to do. 2. Writer writes the choice in one short invented sentence. 3. Adult asks what small, gentle change happens because of the choice. 4. Writer writes the change as the next-to-last or last sentence.	Gentle Ending Repair Revising an ending that feels abrupt or unclear. 1. Adult reads the ending card and asks which part feels unfinished. 2. Writer marks one place to add a closing choice, object return, feeling, or image. 3. Adult offers two calm wording options and lets the writer choose. 4. Writer writes a cleaner final line on a fresh slip.

Finish one story ending later

ONE PAPER PASS OBJECT RETURN Lantern Return Slip Bring back a pretend lantern near the ending and write what it means now: _____. A family reader can ask which earlier story moment the lantern echoes: _____.	CALM PENCIL PASS FINAL IMAGE Pocket Pebble Close Write the last image of a pocket pebble resting in a made-up place: _____. A family reader can ask why that image feels like an ending: _____.
SINGLE SLIP CLOSING CHOICE Ribbon Gate Choice Write the character's final choice at an invented ribbon gate: _____. A family reader can ask what gentle change follows that choice: _____.	FOLDED SLIP ECHO LINE Cloud Bell Echo Repeat one earlier made-up phrase in a new ending line: _____. A family reader can ask how the phrase feels different at the end: _____.
FAMILY TABLE PASS FINAL FEELING Blue Button Feeling Choose one final feeling for a character holding a blue button: _____. A family reader can ask what action shows that feeling: _____.	PAPER-ONLY PASS CONSEQUENCE Tiny Bridge Ending Write what changes after a character crosses a tiny pretend bridge: _____. A family reader can ask which choice made the change happen: _____.
QUIET STORY PASS OBJECT MEANING Moon Thread Return Bring back a moon thread and write why it matters at the end: _____. A family reader can ask what the moon thread helped the character understand: _____.	ONE-CARD PASS VISUAL ENDING Garden Door Last Look Write the final look at an invented garden door: _____. A family reader can ask what detail makes the door feel finished: _____.
SHARED ALOUD PASS GENTLE CLOSURE Quiet Market Goodbye Write a short goodbye line for a made-up market character: _____. A family reader can ask what the goodbye leaves behind: _____.	REVISION PASS GENTLE REVISION Fresh Ending Slip Rewrite one ending line so it is clearer or softer: _____. A family reader can ask which word made the ending stronger: _____.

Optional share prompts

- Optional, adult-led offline prompt: my fictional ending choice is _____.
- Optional, adult-led offline prompt: the pretend object that came back was _____.
- Optional, adult-led offline prompt: the final feeling on my paper slip is _____.
- Optional, adult-led offline prompt: my ending echo line uses the word _____.
- Optional, adult-led offline prompt: the last image in the made-up story is _____.
- Optional, adult-led offline prompt: one gentle change at the end is _____.
- Optional, adult-led offline prompt: I made the ending clearer by changing _____.
- Optional, adult-led offline prompt: an adult can add one invented closing detail here: _____.

Moon Muffin Last Crumb Tuck

Adult setup: Adult: Place the card beside a blank backpack flap shape and offer two pretend moon-market ending choices: _____.

Pick the ending that best fits the moon muffin mix-up and write the final choice on paper: _____.



Moon Muffin Market

Ending choice Ending choice: The moon muffin helper finally chooses to _____. _____	Final feeling Feeling check: At the final crumb counter, the helper feels _____. _____
Object return Object return: Bring back one earlier market item before the ending: _____. _____	Echo line Echo line: Repeat one tiny word or clue from the beginning in the ending: _____. _____
Final line Final line: Write the last market sentence with a soft landing: _____. _____	Revise ending Revise ending: Add one moon-market detail that makes the choice clearer: _____. _____

Quiet option: Circle one ending choice and copy only three final words: _____. **Take-home line:** Use this card to finish another pretend market tale with one clear choice: _____.

Puddle Planet Soft Stamp Close

Adult setup: Adult: Set out the card and ask which pretend ripple-mail feeling should end the story: _____.

Write the ending by showing how the puddle mail helper feels after the tiny mix-up settles: _____.



Puddle Planet Post Office

Ending choice
Ending choice: The ripple-mail helper can finish by sorting, waiting, or asking for help: _____.

Object return
Object return: Bring back one pretend stamp, tag, or shell slip near the last line: _____.

Final line
Final line: End with one calm puddle-planet sentence: _____.

Final feeling
Feeling ending: The helper feels _____ because the puddle mail is finally _____.

Echo line
Echo line: Let the final ripple echo an earlier sound or word: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: Replace one plain feeling word with a stronger puddle word: _____.

Quiet option: Choose one feeling word first, then fill the ending blank: _____. **Take-home line:** Finish another pretend mail tale by naming the final feeling: _____.

Buttonwood Ticket Comes Back

Adult setup: Adult: Place a small paper ticket shape beside this card and invite an invented object return: _____.

Finish the library-train story by bringing back an object that mattered earlier: _____.



Buttonwood Library Train

Ending choice
Ending choice: The traveler ends by keeping, returning, or trading the ticket clue: _____.

Object return
Object return: The earlier object that comes back in the last scene is _____.

Final line
Final line: Write the last library-train sentence after the object returns: _____.

Final feeling
Feeling prompt: When the object returns, the traveler feels _____.

Echo line
Echo line: Repeat one shelf, bell, wheel, or bookmark clue in the ending: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: Add one object detail so the ending feels connected to the beginning: _____.

Quiet option: Draw the returning object, then write one ending word: _____. **Take-home line:** Try an object-return ending in another invented train tale: _____.

Button Bakery Map Question Loop

Adult setup: Adult: Read one pretend map question aloud and ask the writer to echo it near the ending: _____.

Use the last line to answer or repeat one bakery-map question in a new way: _____.



Button Bakery Map Mix-Up

Ending choice
Ending choice: The map-mender ends by folding, turning, or labeling the pretend map:

Final feeling
Feeling prompt: After the question comes back, the map-mender feels _____.

Object return
Object return: Bring back one button, crumb, ribbon, or folded corner in the ending:

Echo line
Question echo: The question that comes back near the end is _____.

Final line
Final line: Write a final sentence that answers the echoed question: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: Move one earlier question clue closer to the final line: _____.

Quiet option: Copy the question mark shape and fill one answer word: _____.

Take-home line: End another pretend map tale by echoing one question: _____.

Teacup Weather Tiny Blue Surprise

Adult setup: Adult: Choose one pretend weather symbol together and leave room for a tiny surprise at the end: _____.

Finish the teacup weather story with a small surprise that stays gentle and make-believe: _____.



Teacup Town Weather Window

Ending choice
Ending choice: The weather watcher ends by opening, closing, or tapping the tiny pane: _____.

Object return
Object return: Bring back one saucer, ribbon, spoon, or cloud tag in the final moment: _____.

Final line
Final line: Write the gentle surprise ending for Teacup Town: _____.

Final feeling
Feeling prompt: The small surprise makes the watcher feel _____.

Echo line
Echo line: Let one earlier weather word return in the last sentence: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: Make the surprise smaller, clearer, and more teacup-like: _____.

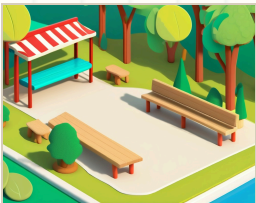
Quiet option: Draw the surprise symbol and write one final phrase: _____.

Take-home line: Add one tiny surprise ending to another pretend weather tale: _____.

Pocket Park Notice Tomorrow Hint

Adult setup: Adult: Place this card beside a blank pretend notice and ask for an invented next-day hint only: _____.

End the pocket-park story by hinting at what the notice might invite next in the make-believe world: _____.



Pocket Park Notice Board

Ending choice Ending choice: The notice helper ends by pinning, reading, or saving the pretend note: _____ _____	Final feeling Feeling prompt: The helper feels _____ when the notice finally makes sense. _____ _____
Object return Object return: Bring back one ribbon tack, leaf slip, or bench tag near the ending: _____ _____	Echo line Echo line: Repeat one notice word from the beginning in the final hint: _____. _____ _____
Final line Final line: Write the next-day hint without naming any real place: _____. _____ _____	Revise ending Revise ending: Add one pocket-park detail that makes the hint feel ready but not finished: _____ _____

Quiet option: Choose one hint word and place it on the pretend notice: _____. **Take-home line:** Make another broad next-day hint for a fictional notice-board ending: _____.

Spoon Ferry Last Lunchbox Bell

Adult setup: Adult: place this ending card after the draft and invite one gentle pretend choice, not any narrow real-world fact: _____.

Kid: choose what the spoon ferry helper does before the lunchbox harbor quiets: _____.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Ending choice
Ending choice: The helper can ring the tiny bell, return the crumb flag, or wave from the napkin pier; I choose _____.

Object return
Object return: bring back one pretend object from earlier, such as the spoon flag or button buoy: _____.

Final line
Final line: write the last sentence with the ferry, bell, or quiet water: _____.

Final feeling
Feeling clue: after the choice, the harbor feels _____.

Echo line
Echo clue: repeat one harbor word from the beginning in a new way: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: change one plain action into a clearer ending choice: _____.

Quiet option: circle one object and fill only this ending blank: _____. **Take-away line:** a final choice can close a pretend ferry story: _____.

Acorn Errand Desk Return Slip

Adult setup: Adult: set this card beside the last paragraph and ask which invented errand object should come back: _____.

Kid: pick one acorn office object from the story and use it to close the ending: _____.



Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Ending choice
Ending choice: decide whether the helper files, folds, or carries the final errand slip:

Final feeling
Feeling clue: show how the helper feels when the errand desk finally makes sense:

Object return
Object return: bring back a walnut tag, leaf stamp, pebble bell, or invented desk slip:

Echo line
Echo clue: reuse one word from the opening errand mix-up: _____

Final line
Final line: write a closing sentence that names the returned object: _____

Revise ending
Revise ending: replace a vague finish with one object that proves the errand is done:

Quiet option: draw the object first, then name it here: _____
Take-away line: an object from earlier can make a small ending feel complete: _____

Seed Map Last Drawer Question

Adult setup: Adult: invite the writer to find one pretend question from the draft and echo it with invented seed-library words: _____.

Kid: write an ending that points back to one question from the map room: _____.



Seed Library Map Room

Ending choice Ending choice: decide whether the seed keeper closes the drawer, opens a new map, or leaves a clue card: _____.	Final feeling Feeling clue: choose the ending feeling after the map question changes: _____.
Object return Object return: bring back one seed bead, folded map, drawer label, or paper key: _____.	Echo line Echo clue: repeat the map-room question with one changed word: _____.
Final line Final line: write the last sentence so the echoed question feels settled or curious: _____.	Revise ending Revise ending: add one earlier map clue so the question echo connects: _____.

Quiet option: copy the question mark, then fill one answer word: _____.

Take-away line: an ending can echo a question without explaining everything: _____.

Rain Gauge Railway Tomorrow Ticket

Adult setup: Adult: ask for one paper ticket, gauge mark, or platform clue that hints at what could happen later: _____.

Kid: end the railway story with one quiet clue that could lead to another pretend ride: _____.



Rain Gauge Railway

Ending choice
Ending choice: decide whether the train pauses, turns back, or follows a new puddle signal:
_____.

Object return
Object return: bring back a blue ticket, tilted gauge, brass bell, or bead of rain: _____.

Final line
Final line: write the last sentence with tomorrow's pretend ticket clue: _____.

Final feeling
Feeling clue: show whether the platform feels calm, curious, bright, or rain-soft at the end:
_____.

Echo line
Echo clue: reuse one railway sound from the beginning: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: add one small future hint without adding a whole new scene: _____.

Quiet option: mark one gauge line and write only the hint word: _____. **Take-away line:** a next-day hint can leave the railway tale open but finished: _____.

Moss Observatory Final Glow

Adult setup: Adult: invite one invented image from the moss signals, sky chart, or lookout shelf to close the story: _____.

Kid: write the ending so the reader can picture the last quiet observatory moment: _____.



Moss Message Observatory

Ending choice
Ending choice: decide whether the observer leaves the moss dial glowing, folded, or turned toward the sky: _____.

Object return
Object return: bring back a moss dial, pebble lens, folded sky chart, or lantern note: _____.

Final line
Final line: write a closing image with light, moss, stone, or sky: _____.

Final feeling
Feeling clue: name the final feeling the closing image should carry: _____.

Echo line
Echo clue: reuse one moss message word from earlier in the story: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: replace an explanation with one picture the reader can see: _____.

Quiet option: sketch the final image, then write two words for it: _____.

Take-away line: one clear final picture can close a pretend observatory story: _____.

Tidepool Clock Shell Return

Adult setup: Adult: place the card beside a blank backpack pocket shape and choose one invented tidepool object together: _____.

End your tidepool lab tale by bringing one make-believe object back to where it belongs: _____.



Tidepool Timekeepers Lab

Ending choice
Ending choice: decide whether the shell clock is returned quietly, proudly, or with a tiny new tick:

Object return
Object return: name the shell, bead, bubble note, or kelp tag that comes back at the end:

Final line
Final line: write the last sentence that leaves the lab calm and clear: _____

Final feeling
Feeling prompt: show how the timekeeper feels after the tidepool object is safely back:

Echo line
Echo prompt: repeat one early tidepool detail in a fresh way near the final sentence:

Revise ending
Revise ending: add one tide, clock, shell, or ripple detail so the ending feels earned:

Quiet option: draw the returned object first, then write only its ending word: _____. **Take-along line:** fold this card into a pretend backpack pocket and add one more calm ending clue: _____.

Revision River Ferry Last Dock

Adult setup: Adult: offer one plain ferry sentence and one blank backpack pocket shape for a stronger ending: _____.

Rewrite the ferry ending so the final dock shows what changed in the make-believe draft: _____.



Revision River Ferry

Ending choice
Ending choice: choose the ferry landing, cargo swap, or dock bell that closes the tale best:

Object return
Object return: bring back one paper oar tag, lantern slip, or basket clue from earlier in the tale:

Final line
Final line: write the closing ferry sentence with one concrete detail: _____.

Final feeling
Feeling prompt: show what the ferry helper understands after the revised crossing:

Echo line
Echo prompt: echo one word from the first ferry sentence, but make it sharper now:

Revise ending
Revise ending: replace one vague ending word with a clearer river, dock, basket, or bell word:

Quiet option: write old ending arrow new ending before making the full change: _____. **Take-along line:** keep this card in the pretend backpack pocket and revise one more final sentence: _____.

Clue Label Tower Echo Tag

Adult setup: Adult: set out two pretend exhibit labels and invite the writer to keep every clue made up: _____.

End the tower museum tale by letting the final label echo the question from earlier: _____.



Clue Label Tower Museum

Ending choice
Ending choice: decide whether the label gives an answer, a tiny hint, or a new gentle question: _____.

Object return
Object return: bring back one exhibit tag, ribbon card, or folded label from the opening: _____.

Final line
Final line: write the museum ending sentence that lets the label feel complete: _____.

Final feeling
Feeling prompt: show how the clue finder feels when the final tag makes sense: _____.

Echo line
Echo prompt: repeat the tale's first question with one changed word at the end: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: move one clue closer to the final label so the question echo is clear: _____.

Quiet option: write only the echoed question and circle the changed word: _____. **Take-along line:** tuck this card into a pretend backpack pocket and invent one more final label: _____.

Compass Craft Final Turn

Adult setup: Adult: place a paper compass beside the card and name every direction as invented story play: _____.

End the compass craft tale by choosing one final turn and showing why it fits: _____.



Compass Craft Academy

Ending choice
Ending choice: choose north-thread, east-bead, south-fold, or west-paper as the final turn:

Final feeling
Feeling prompt: show what the crafter feels after choosing the final direction: _____.

Object return
Object return: bring back one paper needle, bead string, fold card, or compass tag at the end:

Echo line
Echo prompt: echo one early direction word so the ending connects to the beginning:

Final line
Final line: write the last compass sentence with the choice and its clear reason: _____.

Revise ending
Revise ending: add one small clue that makes the final turn feel planned, not random:

Quiet option: mark one compass point silently, then write its ending reason: _____.

Take-along line: slide this card into a pretend backpack pocket and add a new choice ending: _____.

Binding Day Boardwalk Promise Knot

Adult setup: Adult: fold a blank paper booklet and ask for only invented boardwalk, page, and button details: _____.

End the binding day tale by writing the promise that ties the final page together: _____.



Binding Day Boardwalk

Ending choice
Ending choice: choose whether the promise is kept with a button, thread loop, page clasp, or folded sign:

Object return
Object return: bring back one button tag, thread loop, page corner, or boardwalk token from earlier:

Final line
Final line: write the promise line that closes the booklet and leaves one bright image:

Final feeling
Feeling prompt: show how the binder feels when the loose pages finally fit: _____

Echo line
Echo prompt: echo the first page's worry with a calmer final version: _____

Revise ending
Revise ending: add one earlier object to the final promise so the ending feels connected:

Quiet option: write only the promise and the object that helps keep it: _____. **Take-along line:** keep this card with the pretend backpack pocket and write another promise ending: _____.